

# Dad and the Cat and the Tree

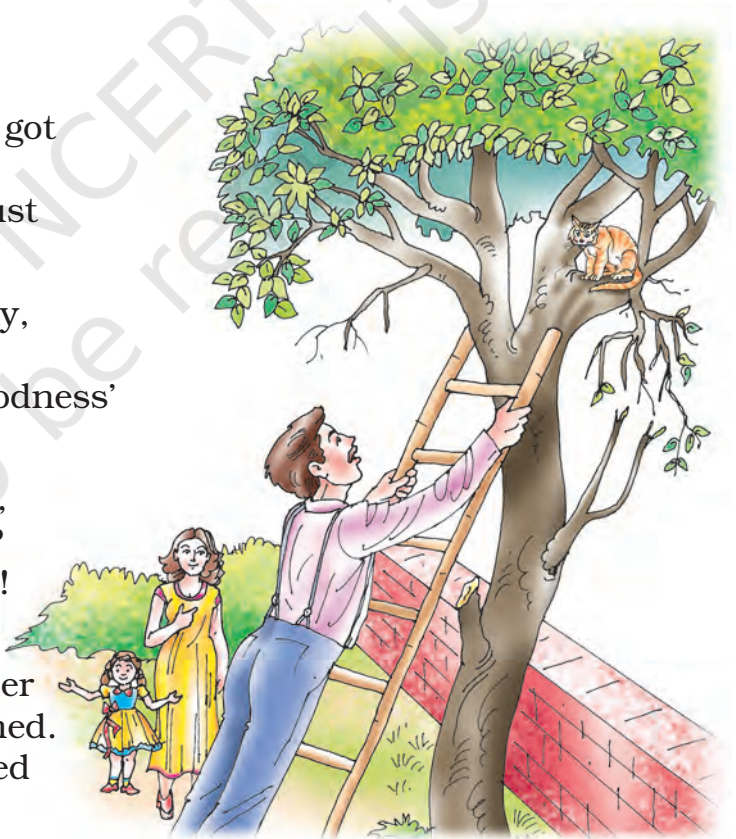
*Have you ever seen a cat climbing a tree? Sometimes a cat may climb too high and get stuck in the tree. The poor thing can't come down without help. How would you help it? Surely, not like Dad in the poem. Is Dad a good climber? What were his plans? Read the poem to find out.*

This morning a cat got  
Stuck in our tree.  
Dad said, "Right, just  
Leave it to me."

The tree was wobbly,  
The tree was tall.  
Mum said, "For goodness'  
Sake don't fall!"

"Fall?" scoffed Dad,  
"A climber like me?  
Child's play, this is!  
You wait and see."

He got out the ladder  
From the garden shed.  
It slipped. He landed  
In the flower bed.





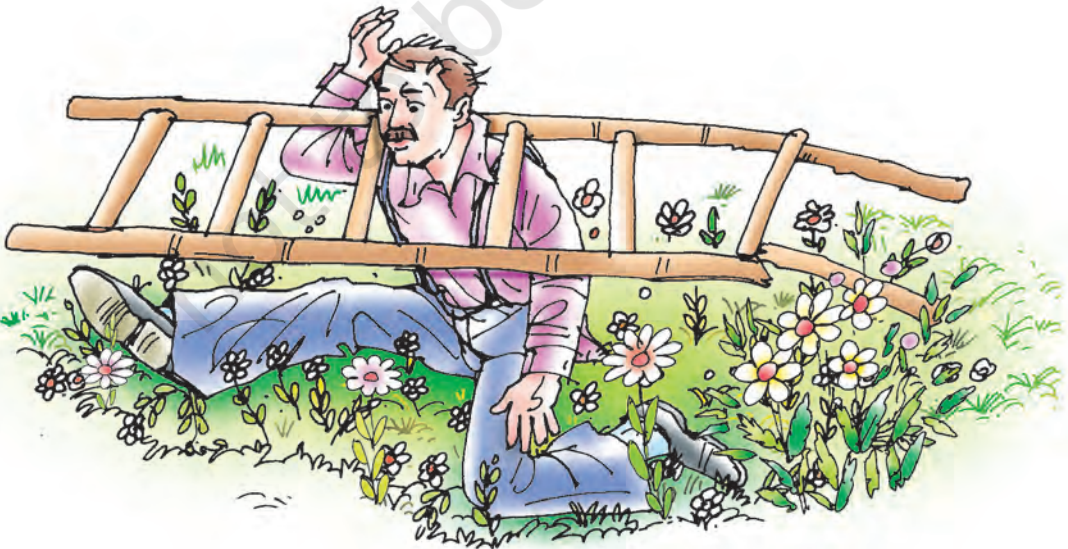
“Never mind,” said Dad,  
Brushing the dirt  
Off his hair and his face  
And his trousers and his shirt,

“We’ll try Plan B. Stand  
Out of the way!”  
Mum said, “Don’t fall  
Again, O.K.?”

“Fall again?” said Dad.  
“Funny joke!”  
Then he swung himself up  
On a branch. It broke.

Dad landed wallop  
Back on the deck.  
Mum said, “Stop it,  
You’ll break your neck!”

“Rubbish!” said Dad.  
“Now we’ll try Plan C.  
Easy as winking  
To a climber like me!”





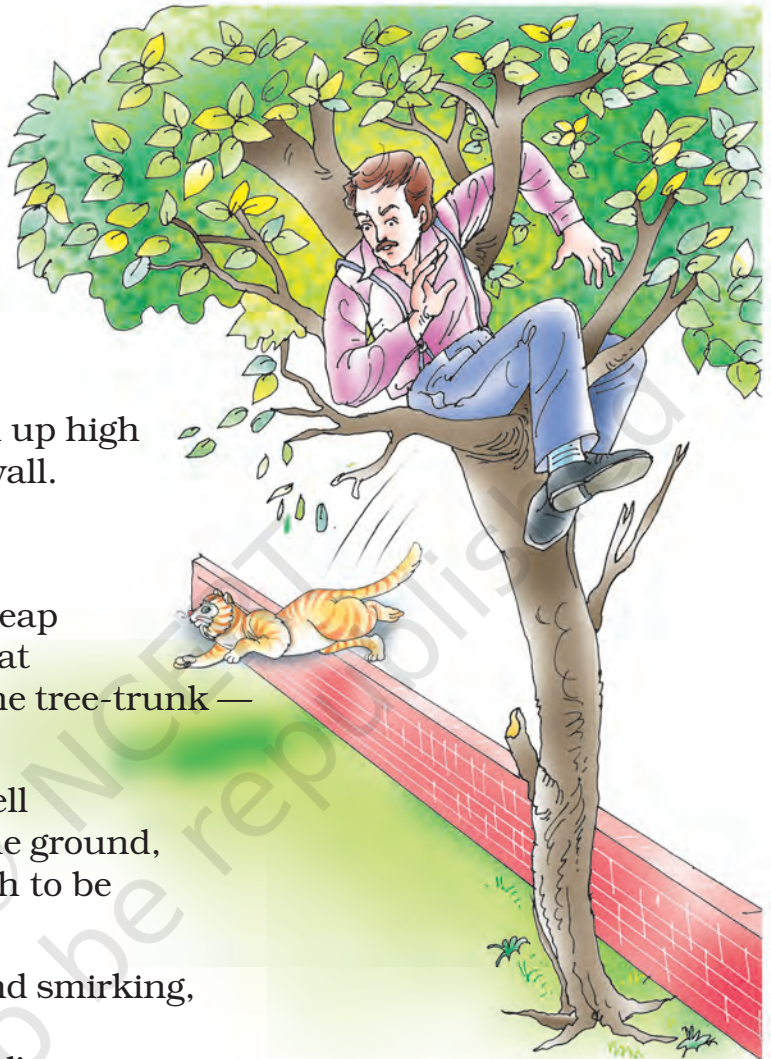
Then he climbed up high  
On the garden wall.  
Guess what?  
He didn't fall!

He gave a great leap  
And he landed flat  
In the crook of the tree-trunk —  
Right on the cat!

The cat gave a yell  
And sprang to the ground,  
Pleased as Punch to be  
Safe and sound.

So it's smiling and smirking,  
Smug as can be,  
But poor old Dad's  
Still

Stuck  
Up  
The  
Tree!



KIT WRIGHT



## GLOSSARY

**wobbly:** unsteady

**for goodness' sake:** an exclamation expressing protest

**scoffed:** laughed mockingly

**child's play:** very easy to do

**landed wallop:** fell heavily

**pleased as Punch:** very pleased

**safe and sound:** unhurt

## Working with the Poem

1. Why was Dad sure he wouldn't fall?
2. Which phrase in the poem expresses Dad's self-confidence best?
3. Describe Plan A and its consequences.
4. Plan C was a success. What went wrong then?
5. The cat was very happy to be on the ground. Pick out the phrase used to express this idea.
6. Describe the Cat and Dad situation in the beginning and at the end of the poem.
7. Why and when did Dad say each of the following?
  - (i) Fall?
  - (ii) Never mind
  - (iii) Funny joke
  - (iv) Rubbish
8. Do you find the poem humorous? Read aloud lines which make you laugh.

### Do you know...

*If you show love to plants or expose them to classical music, they grow well. Is this true ?*

*Answer on page 113*

